position, as I saw no other way out from the violence and injustice and waste and misery of the existing order. He might disagree about the methods but not about the ideal. So I thought then, but I realise now that there are basic differences between Gandhiji's ideals and the socialist objective.

To go back to Delhi in February 1931. The Gandhi-Irwin talks went on from time to time, and then they came to a sudden stop. For several days Gandhiji was not sent for by the Viceroy, and it seemed to us that the break had come. The members of the Working Committee prepared to leave Delhi for their respective provinces. Before leaving we conferred together about our future plans and civil disobedience (which was in theory still going on). We felt certain that as soon as the break was definitely announced we would have no further opportunity of meeting and conferring together. We expected arrest, and we had been told, and it seemed likely, that the Government would launch a fierce offensive against the Congress; something much fiercer than we had so far had. So we met together at what we thought was our final meeting, and we passed various resolutions to guide the movement in the future. One resolution had a certain significance. So far, the practice had been for each Acting-President to nominate his successor in case of arrest, and also to fill by nomination the vacancies in the Working Committee. The substitute Working Committees hardly functioned and had little authority to take the initiative in any matter. They could only go to prison. There was always a risk, however, that this continuous process of substitution might place the Congress in a false position. There were obvious dangers to it. The Working Committee in Delhi, therefore, decided that in future there should be no nominations of acting-Presidents or substitute members. So long as any members (or member) of the original Committee were out of gaol they would function as the full Committee. When all of them were in prison, then there would be no Committee functioning, but, we said rather grandiloquently, the powers of the Working Committee would then vest in each man and woman in the country, and we called upon them to carry on the struggle uncompromisingly.

This resolution was a brave lead for a continuance of the fight, and it left no loophole for compromise. It was also a recognition of the fact that it was becoming increasingly difficult for our headquarters to keep in touch with all parts of the country and to issue instructions regularly. This was inevitable, as most of our workers were well-known men and